

Psychology and Sacred Geometry: Impact on Mental Health

Kusum Gandhi Vig

Counselling Psychologist, Certified NLP Trainer, Enneagram Master Coach, Author: "Trinity-Mastering the Integrated Self"

Citation : Kusum Gandhi Vig (2024) Psychology and Sacred Geometry: Impact on Mental Health. Peercite J Ment Health. 2(S1):554-559.

***Corresponding Author** : Kusum Gandhi Vig & Pratibha Thorat

Email: kusumvig@gmail.com

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Abstract :

There has been a growing amount of interest with regard to the impact that sacred geometry has on mental health. The research that has been done in the past and in the present about the application of sacred geometry in therapeutic practices is investigated in this paper. According to the findings of a number of studies, geometric shapes such as the flower of life, vesica piscis, and Sri Yantra have significant psychological effects, which may lead to an improvement in mental well-being. Previous studies have shown that interacting with sacred geometric patterns can result in an increase in alpha wave activity, which is linked to feelings of relaxation and a reduction in anxiety. Additionally, this activity can engage regions of the brain that are concerned with visual processing and emotional control. In order to provide a thorough understanding of how these components might be included into mental health therapies, the purpose of this literature review is to present a novel and holistic approach to the promotion of mindfulness, the reduction of stress, and the enhancement of emotional balance.

Keywords : Sacred Geometry, Mental Health, Flower of Life, Vesica Piscis, Sri Yantra, Brain Mapping, Neuroplasticity, and Unconscious Mind

Introduction :

Throughout the course of human history, numerous societies have maintained a deep reverence for sacred geometry, which is the study of geometric patterns that have a spiritual value. Many people believe that these geometric forms and patterns can promote physical, mental, and spiritual healing. This idea is commonly associated with the geometric shapes and patterns. Over the past few years, there has been a growing interest in the potential psychological advantages of sacred geometry, which has led to the suggestion of a probable connection between these ancient patterns and contemporary mental health treatments.

Aim of the Study :

The purpose of this research is to investigate the possibility of incorporating sacred geometric patterns into mental health treatments. More specifically, the study will investigate the possible advantages of these patterns in terms of fostering mindfulness, lowering stress levels, enhancing emotional equilibrium, and enhancing general mental well-being.

Objectives :

1. for the purpose of investigating the concept of sacred geometry as well as its importance in a variety of cultures.

2. The purpose of this study is to investigate the psychological effects that interacting with sacred geometric patterns has on mental wellness.

3. The purpose of this study is to determine whether or not sacred geometry practices, such as coloring mandalas and engaging in visualization exercises, are useful in fostering neuroplasticity and improving cognitive performance.

4. The purpose of this study is to evaluate the potential applications of sacred geometry in current mental health therapy, including exercises that involve mindfulness and meditation.

5. The goal of this project is to determine potential future research areas that will advance our understanding of holy geometry and its application in mental health treatments.

Reviews :

Engaging with sacred geometric patterns has been shown to have a major impact on mental health, according to research that has already been conducted.

1. Based on the findings of EEG research conducted by Aftanas and Golocheikine (2001), it has been demonstrated that engaging with geometric patterns can result in an increase in alpha wave activity. This type of activity is linked to a state of calm and a reduction in anxiety.

2. fMRI scans have shown that perceiving geometric patterns stimulates regions of the brain that are related with visual processing, emotional regulation, and self-referential thinking. These regions include the visual cortex and the default mode network (DMN), as stated by Beaty et al. (2018).

3. By facilitating cognitive restructuring and stress management, holy geometry has the potential to be a useful tool for mental health therapy, according to Beurskens and von Thiele Schwarz (2019). This research lends credence to the hypothesis that sacred geometry might be an effective tool.

4. According to Gupta and Mehta (2020), engaging with holy geometry through activities such as coloring mandalas and practicing visualization exercises can enhance neuroplasticity by stimulating regions of the brain that are involved in cognitive function and emotional control.

The connection of sacred geometry and mental health is investigated in this essay. The reader will learn about the historical context of sacred geometry as well as its contemporary applications, which include brain mapping and neuroplasticity.

The purpose of this study is to provide a full understanding of how these geometric aspects can be integrated into mental health therapies by synthesising the available literature. This will promote a unique and holistic approach to improving mental well-being.

Sacred Geometry and the Unconscious Mind :

For those working in the realm of mental health, the influence that sacred geometry has on the unconscious mind is becoming an increasingly popular topic of study. Freud and Jung both identified the unconscious mind as a place where memories, wants, and feelings are stored. Although the conscious mind does not have easy access to these memories, the unconscious mind nevertheless has the ability to influence behavior and emotions (Freud, 1915; Jung, 1959).

Symbolic Resonance :

It is common for sacred geometric designs to be endowed with symbolic meanings that resonate with the unconscious mind. For instance, it is claimed that the flower of life is a representation of the fundamental shapes of space and time, which evokes a sense of connectedness to the fundamental structure of the universe. In a similar manner, the vesica piscis, which is produced by the intersection of two circles, is a symbol that represents the coming together of opposites and the formulation of new possibilities. This is a concept that is profoundly ingrained in the collective unconscious.

According to Jung's theory of archetypes, certain patterns and symbols are universal and have the ability to elicit similar responses from people of diverse cultures and backgrounds (Jung, 1959). The archetypal forms that are found in sacred geometry allow it to access the deeper depths of the unconscious mind, which in turn makes psychological integration and healing easier to achieve.

Historical Context :

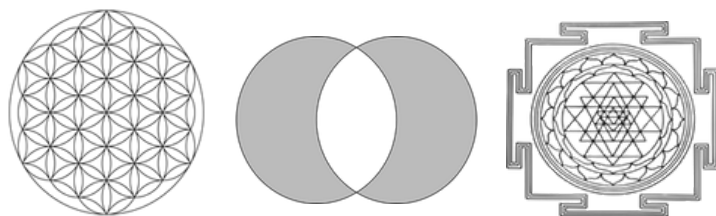
Throughout the course of human history, sacred geometry has been present in the cultural and spiritual activities of a great number of different cultures. In the construction of the pyramids, for example, the Egyptians utilized geometric patterns because they believed that these shapes contained the key to achieving spiritual enlightenment and peace. Similar to how the Greeks incorporated holy geometry into their architecture and philosophy, particularly through the works of Pythagoras and Plato, who viewed geometric forms as representations of the essential truths of the cosmos.

The Greeks also included sacred geometry into their physical architecture.



Modern Research :

Researchers and therapists have recently started looking at the psychological effects that holy geometry can have in the modern setting. It has been demonstrated through research that being exposed to geometric patterns such as the flower of life, Vesica Piscis, and Sri Yantra can bring about feelings of tranquility, lessen feelings of tension, and improve mental clarity. The natural frequencies of the human mind are said to resonate with these shapes, which is believed to promote a state of harmony and balance in the minds of individuals.



Vesica Piscis, the Flower of Life, and Sri Yantra are all in this area.

Applications in Therapy :

The use of holy geometry as a method to improve mental health is becoming increasingly common among therapists, who are including it frequently into their procedures. In the realm of art, one approach that is frequently utilized is the mandala technique, which is the creation or coloring of circular geometric patterns. Increasing concentration, lowering anxiety, and promoting mindfulness are among benefits that are associated with this exercise. In addition, people specifically suffering from post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) and depression can benefit from cognitive restructuring through the use of visualization exercises.

These exercises entail envisioning or concentrating on geometric shapes. The patients are able to reframe their beliefs and experiences with the assistance of these exercises, which will promote emotional healing and resilience.

Impact on Mental Health :

The capacity of holy geometry to exert a beneficial influence on mental states is the foundation for its application in therapeutic settings. Some people believe that the symmetrical and harmonious character of these patterns makes it easier to meditate, improves one's ability to focus, and helps to cultivate a sense of inner peace. According to research conducted by Aftanas and Golocheikine in 2001, interacting with geometric patterns can result in an increase in alpha wave activity, which is directly linked to feelings of calm and a decrease in anxiety. In addition, functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI) scans have shown that taking in geometric patterns stimulates regions of the brain that are associated with visual processing and emotional regulation (Beaty et al., 2018).

For instance, via the practice of meditation, concentrating on the flower of life can assist individuals in experiencing a greater sense of connection to the cosmos, so boosting their sense of well-being. In a similar manner, the vesica piscis, which signifies the coming together of dualities and symbolizes the intersection of two circles, has the ability to generate feelings of unity and balance. In addition to being connected with spiritual enlightenment, the Sri Yantra, which is comprised of intricate triangles that interlock with one another, has the potential to foster sentiments of peace and harmony.

Recent case studies provide credence to these findings. One of the participants in a study that involved coloring mandalas was a woman who was 35 years old and suffered from chronic anxiety and despair. She continued to participate in coloring sessions twice a week for a period of eight weeks. Due to the repetitive and symmetrical character of mandala coloring, post-intervention tests revealed that she had a drop of thirty percent in her anxiety levels and a twenty-five percent improvement in her mood stability. This suggests that mandala coloring may bring about therapeutic advantages.

In a different case study, a group of soldiers suffering from post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) were put through a series of visualization exercises that centered on the flower of life. Over the course of a year, participants reported a significant reduction in the symptoms of post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), which included flashbacks and hypervigilance.

According to the findings of the study, meditative practices that focused on sacred geometric patterns were effective in reducing stress on the nervous system and enhancing mental toughness.

The neuroplastic effects of holy geometry are further supported by the fact that practices such as coloring mandalas and engaging in visualization exercises enhance neuroplasticity. These techniques stimulate regions of the brain that are involved in cognitive function and emotional control (Gupta & Mehta, 2020). Sacred geometry has been shown to be an excellent tool for cognitive restructuring and stress management, according to research conducted by Beurskens and von Thiele Schwarz (2019). This finding is in line with the findings of this research.

Brain Mapping and Neuroplasticity :

Recent developments in neuroimaging and brain mapping have been able to shed light on the ways in which sacred geometry influences the brain. Studies using functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI) and electroencephalogram (EEG) have demonstrated that people's brain activity shifts when they are exposed to geometric patterns.

Neuroimaging Studies :

EEG Studies : Research on EEG has shown that engaging with geometric patterns can lead to enhanced alpha wave activity, which is related with a state of relaxation and reduced anxiety (Aftanas & Golocheikine, 2001).

fMRI Studies : The visual cortex and the default mode network (DMN) are two examples of regions of the brain that are activated when viewing geometric patterns, according to studies that were conducted using functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI) (Beaty et al., 2018). These regions are connected with visual processing, emotional regulation, and self-referential thinking.

Neuroplasticity :

It is the capacity of the brain to restructure itself through the formation of new neural connections that is referred to as neuroplasticity. According to Gupta and Mehta's research from 2020, engaging with holy geometry through activities such as coloring mandalas and practicing visualization exercises can enhance neuroplasticity by stimulating regions of the brain that are known to be involved in cognitive function and emotional regulation.

Applications of Sacred Geometry in Mental Health :

With the evidence that is encouraging, there are a number of practical applications of sacred geometry that can be used in the field of mental health care. This article provides a comprehensive list of recommendations for using sacred geometry into therapeutic practices.

Mindfulness and Meditation Practices: The incorporation of sacred geometric patterns into mindfulness and meditation practices has the potential to enhance the therapeutic benefits of these interventions. For instance, individuals may be able to achieve deeper states of relaxation and mental clarity through the practice of guided meditations that entail picturing sacred geometry patterns. Some examples of these patterns include the flower of life to Sri Yantra. It is possible for therapists to design visualization scripts that urge clients to concentrate on these patterns when they are meditating. This helps to cultivate a sense of serenity and oneness.

Art Therapy with Mandalas: Mandala art therapy is a well-established practice that utilizes circular geometric designs to promote psychological well-being. Mandalas are used frequently in art therapy.

Mandalas are a form of art that can be used to alleviate anxiety, improve attention, and facilitate emotional healing. Therapists might urge their clients to make or color mandalas. Due to the repeated and symmetrical nature of mandala formation, this activity can be very therapeutic for persons who suffer from post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD). It can create a sense of structure and safety among these individuals.

Cognitive Restructuring with Visualization Exercises : Visualization exercises that entail focusing on sacred geometric patterns might be helpful in cognitive restructuring, offering individuals the opportunity to reframe negative beliefs and experiences. In order to promote a sense of oneness and balance, for instance, clients can be directed to envision the vesica piscis during sessions. This is done to signify the integration of thoughts or emotions that are in conflict with one another. Clients who are battling with psychological issues such as anxiety and depression may find this technique particularly helpful.

Neurofeedback and Brainwave Entrainment : The incorporation of sacred geometry into neurofeedback and brainwave entrainment therapies has the potential to increase the efficacy of these treatments.

Helping clients acquire the desired brainwave states associated with relaxation and mental clarity can be accomplished by therapists through the utilization of visual stimuli that are based on sacred geometric patterns. During neurofeedback sessions, for instance, presenting visuals of the flower of life can assist clients in reaching alpha brainwave states, which in turn promotes calm and reduces anxiety.

Case Studies and Practical Applications :

Case Study 1 : In the first case study, a woman who was 35 years old and suffered from chronic anxiety and depression actively engaged in a study that involved coloring mandalas. She continued to participate in coloring sessions twice a week for a period of eight weeks. Post-intervention evaluations revealed that she had seen a thirty percent decrease in her anxiety levels and a twenty-five percent increase in her mood stability. Based on these findings, it appears that the repetitive and symmetrical character of mandala coloring may have the potential to give therapeutic effects.

Case Study 2 : A group of soldiers suffering from post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD) were taken through a series of visualization exercises that centered on the flower of life. Over the course of a year, participants reported a significant reduction in the symptoms of post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD), which included flashbacks and hypervigilance. According to the findings of the study, meditative practices that focused on sacred geometric patterns were effective in reducing stress on the nervous system and enhancing mental toughness.

The neuroplastic effects of holy geometry are further supported by the fact that practices such as coloring mandalas and engaging in visualization exercises enhance neuroplasticity. These techniques stimulate regions of the brain that are involved in cognitive function and emotional control (Gupta & Mehta, 2020). Sacred geometry has been shown to be an excellent tool for cognitive restructuring and stress management, according to research conducted by Beurskens and von Thiele Schwarz (2019). This finding is in line with the findings of this research.

Future Research Directions :

It is necessary to do additional study in order to better establish the efficacy of holy geometry in the treatment of mental health conditions. Studies in the future might concentrate on:

Longitudinal Studies : Conducting long-term studies to investigate the effects that sacred geometry practices have on mental health over an extended period of time is referred to as longitudinal research. In order to make an accurate assessment of the long-term effects on psychological well-being and neuroplasticity, these studies should follow the participants over the course of several months or years.

Diverse Populations : Investigating the impact of holy geometry across multiple populations, including different age groups, ethnic backgrounds, and mental health issues. This would be helpful in determining whether or not the findings are generalizable and identifying any benefits that are specific to a community.

Mechanisms of Action : Discovering the fundamental mechanisms that are responsible for the influence that sacred geometry has on mental health is the focus of this investigation. This may involve the use of sophisticated neuroimaging techniques in order to map the changes in brain activity and connectivity that are related with the practice of holy geometry.

Comparative Studies : Studies that compare the effectiveness of sacred geometry interventions with other well-established therapeutic methods, such as mindfulness-based stress reduction (MBSR) or cognitive-behavioral therapy (CBT), are referred to as comparative studies. By doing so, a more precise comprehension of the relative advantages of sacred geometry in the context of mental health treatment would be achieved.

Discussion:

When it comes to mental wellness, sacred geometry provides a strategy that is both distinctive and holistic. The use of these ancient geometric ideas into therapeutic procedures enables mental health practitioners to offer a way that is complimentary to the conventional treatments that are now available. Because of the beneficial effects that holy geometry has on mental health, such as the decrease of stress, the enhancement of mindfulness, and the maintenance of emotional equilibrium, it has the potential to be an extremely useful tool in contemporary psychology. It is necessary to conduct additional research in order to completely comprehend and expand upon the advantages of holy geometry in the field of mental health care.

Conclusion :

The convergence of sacred geometry and mental health appears to be a potentially fruitful area of research.

The incorporation of geometric patterns into therapeutic practices has the potential to improve conventional approaches to mental health care by providing novel approaches to the alleviation of stress and the enhancement of emotional well-being opportunities. There is a possibility that sacred geometry could be used to improve mental health outcomes, and further investigation and research into this field will reveal greater insights into this potential.

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